

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Plumbing Workplace English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Plumbers, supervised plumbing apprentices, plumbing service coordinators, and plumbing crew leads.

Original fictional English practice, not plumbing instruction, diagnosis, design, legal advice, or guidance on operating water or drainage systems. Every incident, dimension, product, price basis, and schedule is invented. Do not open, test, dismantle, clear, pressurize, or operate equipment to enact a scenario. Installation, testing, concealed-service assessment, and safety decisions require qualified personnel and project-specific procedures. No universal code or permit rules are stated; source profiles establish occupational context only.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Identifying fixtures and service history

Clarify everyday fixture names and record the source of an account.

02 Clarifying pipe and component specifications

Explain why two size numbers may describe different things.

03 Reconciling fixture layouts and dimensions

Identify inconsistent reference surfaces even when the numbers match.

04 Describing moisture without diagnosing its source

Report moisture evidence without diagnosing a hidden system.

05 Explaining drainage and access terminology

Clarify component terminology while preserving unresolved access requirements.

06 Coordinating interruptions and room access

Distinguish attendance, access, and service-interruption arrangements.

07 Pricing changes and restoration boundaries

Negotiate a revised package without making cost or timing assumptions.

08 Handing over plumbing records and follow-up

Give usable records and separate document follow-up from site attendance.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Identifying fixtures and service history

Clarify everyday fixture names and record the source of an account.

CASE

A tenant reports a problem with the bathroom sink in Unit 3B. The building has both a basin in the bathroom and a utility sink beside it. The tenant means the bathroom basin and noticed water on its cabinet base at 07:00. No source is established.

Teach this move

Clients may use sink for different fixtures. Ask for room, unit, and fixture references rather than inferring a pipe route. This is an information-gathering exercise, not a request to test, dismantle, or operate plumbing.

Vocabulary to check: fixture, branch line, riser, service history.

Model response

Could you confirm whether you mean the bathroom basin or the utility sink beside it? I will record water on the bathroom cabinet base at 07:00 as your observation. That identifies the affected location, not the source. We can link this visit to the correct fixture's service history without assuming which pipe is involved.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision distinguishes a reported location from a diagnosed pipe fault.

Second-round challenge

The manager calls it a riser leak. Preserve the tenant's observation without accepting the unverified pipe diagnosis.

Language-check answers

1. C - fixture Correct. The basin itself is the identified fixture.
2. B - tenant's Correct. The possessive 'tenant's' identifies whose account it is.

05 • Conversations

1. Which sink in Unit 3B? - A plumber clarifies the fictional Unit 3B report with its tenant.

2. Two washrooms with identical basins - A plumber and office manager identify a service location.
3. A complaint changes meaning in retelling - A plumber checks a hotel supervisor's summary of a guest report.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Kitchen, pantry, or utility?

A hotel has a pantry sink and utility sink on Level 2. A request says kitchen sink. The reporter means the pantry sink beside the beverage counter; asset labels are not visible from the corridor.

Role A: Plumber: identify the location without asking anyone to investigate equipment.

Role B: Supervisor: confirm the pantry sink beside the beverage counter; caretaker Noor can arrange access. Earlier job U-17 belongs to the utility sink.

Possible opening: When you say kitchen sink, which room and counter are you referring to?

Success checks

- Name the pantry sink.
- Keep the earlier utility reference separate.
- Agree the access contact.

Add a complication: An earlier job reference belongs to the utility sink.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Clarifying pipe and component specifications

Explain why two size numbers may describe different things.

CASE

A client compares a pipe's nominal designation with a measured outside diameter and thinks the delivered item must be wrong because the numbers differ. The order identifies a product series but the delivery label is incomplete. No material or connection compatibility is verified.

Teach this move

Avoid equating a nominal size with a measured diameter. Product series, material, and connection details matter to comparison. Do not teach joining methods or infer interchangeability from one number.

Vocabulary to check: nominal pipe size, outside diameter, connection type, material specification.

Model response

A nominal pipe size is a designation, not necessarily the measured outside diameter. Different numbers alone do not prove the delivery is wrong or correct. We need the complete product reference and material specification to compare the supplied item with the order. The connection type also needs confirmation before anyone treats it as a match.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The correction avoids declaring either a match or a mismatch prematurely.

Second-round challenge

The supplier offers the same nominal size in another material. Keep compatibility pending the full specification review.

Language-check answers

1. B - nominal pipe size Correct. A nominal designation need not equal the outside diameter.
2. A - connection type Correct. Connection type identifies the joint interface between components.

05 · Conversations

1. The nominal number is not a measurement - A plumber explains the incomplete delivery comparison to a client.
2. The same finish hides a different connection - A plumber checks a proposed faucet substitution with a supplier.
3. A unit disappears in a phone order - A plumber clarifies an incomplete fitting request with a purchasing coordinator.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A replacement cartridge has a longer code

The installed fictional faucet reference is FX40. Its recorded cartridge reference is K40. The supplier offers K40-R, saying the suffix may indicate a revision, but has not confirmed its compatibility with faucet FX40.

Role A: Plumber: request manufacturer confirmation against the installed faucet reference.

Role B: Supplier: you can obtain the full cross-reference but do not yet have it.

Possible opening: What does the R suffix identify, and does the manufacturer confirm this exact replacement?

Success checks

- Use both complete references.
- Distinguish a proposed replacement from a verified match.
- Keep the order decision pending confirmation.

Add a complication: The client thinks a similar name proves interchangeability.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Reconciling fixture layouts and dimensions

Identify inconsistent reference surfaces even when the numbers match.

CASE

The bathroom layout gives a basin centerline 450 millimeters from the finished wall face. The cabinet drawing gives 450 from the framing face. These are different references. The selected basin is B2; no coordinated rough-in detail has been confirmed.

Teach this move

A dimension needs both a starting reference and an endpoint. A fixture selection can also affect the layout. Ask for a coordinated detail rather than choosing whichever drawing seems easier to follow.

Vocabulary to check: fixture schedule, rough-in dimension, centerline, finished wall face.

Model response

Could the designer reconcile the B2 basin position before the layout is released? Both drawings show 450 millimeters, but one measures from the finished wall face and the other from the framing face. Please confirm the intended centerline reference and issue a coordinated detail. Matching numbers do not resolve different measurement origins.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised statement makes the actual coordination issue visible.

Second-round challenge

The client changes basin B2 to B3 during the query. Explain why the new selection also needs coordination.

Language-check answers

1. A - finished wall face Correct. The layout explicitly names the completed wall surface.
2. D - until Correct. 'Not until' identifies the condition still required.

05 • Conversations

1. Four fifty from different walls - A plumber calls the designer about the B2 basin layout.
2. The replacement basin is wider - A plumber and interior designer discuss a changed fixture selection.

3. The drawing is not to scale - A plumber responds to a project coordinator's suggested measurement.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Above the floor, but which floor?

A vanity note gives a connection reference above floor without saying finished floor or structural slab. The floor finish build-up is not yet confirmed.

Role A: Plumber: ask the designer to identify the datum, meaning the reference level.

Role B: Designer: you can coordinate the floor information with the architect.

Possible opening: Does floor here mean the finished floor or the structural slab reference?

Success checks

- Name both possible references.
- Explain why the other room does not resolve this note.
- Request a room-specific coordinated dimension.

Add a complication: The coordinator offers a dimension copied from a different room.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Describing moisture without diagnosing its source

Report moisture evidence without diagnosing a hidden system.

CASE

A shop owner reports a stain below an upstairs washroom. At the visit, the visible ceiling patch is dry. No pipework is visible and no source has been established. The owner asks whether the dry patch proves the leak has stopped.

Teach this move

A visible stain, a tenant's account, and a confirmed active leak are different kinds of information. Time and visibility limit conclusions. Do not direct learners to investigate concealed services or offer repair steps.

Vocabulary to check: active leak, water staining, condensation, concealed pipework.

Model response

The ceiling patch is dry where we can see it during this visit. That does not establish whether there was a leak, whether one has stopped, or where the moisture came from. The concealed pipework has not been assessed. I will retain your timing report and ask for the source question to be reviewed separately.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision avoids turning one observation into a repair claim.

Second-round challenge

The owner suggests condensation. Attribute it as a possibility rather than a diagnosis.

Language-check answers

1. D - active leak Correct. A current escape requires evidence beyond the mere stain.
2. C - remains Correct. 'Remains unconfirmed' states the continuing uncertainty.

05 • Conversations

1. Dry today does not explain yesterday - A plumber discusses the ceiling patch with the shop owner.

2. Wet beside the pipe is not from the pipe - A plumber clarifies an observation with a facilities supervisor.

3. The ceiling report needs attribution - A plumber discusses a complaint relayed by a property manager.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A photograph has no date

A tenant sends a photo of water beneath a basin but later says it was taken last month. Today's condition is unknown; last month's job record is available.

Role A: Plumber: distinguish historical evidence from the current report.

Role B: Tenant: you want a repeat visit but have no current photograph.

Possible opening: When was this image taken, and what have you noticed today?

Success checks

- Correct the photo date.

- Keep today's condition unknown.

- Link the older image to the relevant history without inventing a cause.

Add a complication: The manager has already described the photo as today's active leak.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Explaining drainage and access terminology

Clarify component terminology while preserving unresolved access requirements.

CASE

A cabinet drawing labels a small removable panel for access to a recorded cleanout. The client calls it an extra drain and wants the panel permanently covered. The plumber has not reviewed the enclosure change; the designer must coordinate the access detail.

Teach this move

Explain what a component is, then relate it to the drawing question. Do not describe how to open, clear, dismantle, test, or use drainage components. A client's appearance preference still needs coordinated review.

Vocabulary to check: trap, vent, cleanout, drain line.

Model response

The recorded cleanout is an access point for drainage inspection or servicing, not an extra drain for everyday use. The cabinet panel is shown to provide access to it. Covering that panel changes the reviewed arrangement, so we need the designer and plumbing lead to assess the enclosure detail before treating the change as acceptable.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised explanation gives the component's purpose without an operating instruction.

Second-round challenge

The cabinet supplier offers a different removable panel. Ask for the detail to be reviewed rather than approving it by appearance.

Language-check answers

1. C - drainage service access point Correct. A cleanout provides access for drainage inspection or servicing.
2. B - to Correct. 'Access to' identifies the component to be reached.

05 • Conversations

1. A cleanout is not an extra drain - A plumber explains the cabinet access label to a client.

2. Trap and vent are not interchangeable labels - A plumber clarifies a maintenance note with a property coordinator.

3. The cabinet photo hides the access detail - A plumber and cabinetmaker discuss an unclear drawing package.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A storage plan obscures access

A storeroom layout places a fixed cupboard in front of a recorded drainage access panel. The panel is shown on the service drawing but omitted from the furniture plan.

Role A: Plumber: identify the drawing conflict without prescribing a clearance.

Role B: Facilities client: you can ask the furniture planner to review another location.

Possible opening: The cupboard proposal overlaps the recorded access location; can we review those drawings together?

Success checks

- Use the correct fixed-cupboard status.
- Explain the access conflict.
- Request a coordinated location rather than a nominal label change.

Add a complication: The client offers to label the cupboard as movable although it is specified fixed.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Coordinating interruptions and room access

Distinguish attendance, access, and service-interruption arrangements.

CASE

A plumber's visit is booked for 09:00, but a proposed water-service interruption from 10:00 to 11:00 awaits building-manager confirmation. The request concerns the east washroom only. A tenant thinks the entire building will be unavailable from 09:00. No operating instruction is supplied.

Teach this move

A booked visit does not automatically confirm interruption timing or technical readiness. State only the planned affected services; leave system operation and actual status confirmation to the responsible qualified staff.

Vocabulary to check: access panel, service interruption, interruption notice, affected fixture.

Model response

Our visit is booked for 09:00. The proposed interruption is a separate 10:00-to-11:00 request for the east washroom, still awaiting building-manager confirmation. It is not a confirmed whole-building interruption from 09:00. Please keep the appointment, proposed affected area, and pending interruption approval separate when updating the tenants.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The correction separates two different scheduling facts.

Second-round challenge

The manager confirms ten to eleven for the east washroom. Explain what planning information changes without giving operating directions.

Language-check answers

1. B - awaiting Correct. Awaiting describes the pending approval accurately.
2. A - service visit Correct. The plumber's attendance is the confirmed nine-o'clock event.

05 · Conversations

1. Nine o'clock is the arrival time - A plumber corrects a tenant's understanding of a planned visit.
2. The tenant works nights - A plumber and property coordinator discuss access to an occupied flat.
3. A wall opening is not part of the booking - A plumber discusses service access with a remodeling coordinator.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The school event overlaps the proposed window

A school's proposed washroom interruption is 13:00-14:00. A parent event begins at 13:30. The facilities manager can review an earlier window; no change is confirmed.

Role A: Plumber: report the timing conflict and request a coordinated decision.

Role B: Facilities manager: you can speak to the event lead and service scheduler.

Possible opening: The proposed window overlaps the parent event; can we review the operational conflict before confirming it?

Success checks

- State both timings.
- Do not promise an unassessed completion time.
- Confirm who coordinates the revised proposal.

Add a complication: The event lead assumes the plumber can guarantee completion before guests arrive.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Pricing changes and restoration boundaries

Negotiate a revised package without making cost or timing assumptions.

CASE

The agreed estimate covers replacing basin B1 with the specified model. The client now wants a wall-hung vanity and assumes the fixture allowance covers cabinet changes and redecoration. Those items are not in the estimate. Access requirements and revised plumbing scope have not been assessed.

Teach this move

A budget allowance applies to its stated item, not every related change. Define the requested fixture, cabinet work, plumbing assessment, and restoration boundaries. Leave contract interpretation and payment disputes to appropriate review.

Vocabulary to check: repair estimate, fixture allowance, concealed condition, making good.

Model response

The allowance concerns the specified basin selection; it does not establish inclusion of a new vanity, cabinet changes, or redecoration. We can retain the current proposal or assess a revised package. For the revised option, we need the vanity details and access review before pricing plumbing and making good, meaning restoration of disturbed finishes, separately.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision connects the budget provision to its actual stated scope.

Second-round challenge

The client asks whether a cheaper fixture automatically offsets all cabinet costs. Explain why those are separate quoted items.

Language-check answers

1. A - making good Correct. Making good concerns repair or restoration of disturbed finishes.
2. D - a price for the revised package Correct. The client wants pricing to compare before deciding whether to approve.

05 · Conversations

1. The allowance does not describe the whole vanity - A plumber discusses the changed basin package with a client.
2. A lower fixture price is not a net saving yet - A plumber and homeowner discuss a proposed substitute basin.
3. The estimate did not assess hidden pipework - A plumber and property client discuss a scope limit.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The owner supplies the basin

A quotation includes fitting basin C2 but says client supply. The owner thought the plumber would order it. The supplier has not confirmed availability.

Role A: Plumber: clarify responsibility and the missing delivery information.

Role B: Owner: you can either place the order or request a supply-inclusive quotation.

Possible opening: This quotation includes fitting C2; shall we clarify who supplies the basin?

Success checks

- Separate supply from fitting.
- Offer the two clear next steps.
- Keep attendance timing dependent on confirmed supply and coordination.

Add a complication: The owner wants a guaranteed fitting date before ordering.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Handing over plumbing records and follow-up

Give usable records and separate document follow-up from site attendance.

CASE

Basin B1 is listed in the handover pack, but its care leaflet names the previous model. The supplier's replacement leaflet is pending. Service coordinator Leo accepts document follow-up and will call Monday. A separate cosmetic trim review needs a return visit; no date is booked.

Teach this move

A document can be present but wrong for the supplied fixture. Identify the mismatch, owner, and promised update. An update call is not a visit booking, and a warranty reference is not a guarantee of coverage.

Vocabulary to check: test record, asset register, warranty reference, return visit.

Model response

The pack lists basin B1, but the care leaflet refers to the previous model and should not be presented as its confirmed guidance. Leo has accepted supplier follow-up and will call Monday. The cosmetic trim review is a separate outstanding item with no return date booked yet. Please keep those two follow-ups distinct in the handover.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision identifies the task and avoids converting a call into completion.

Second-round challenge

Leo receives the leaflet but its model suffix differs. Preserve the pending verification rather than declaring the document item closed.

Language-check answers

1. D - document-update call Correct. Leo has committed to a call about the document.
2. C - matching Correct. 'Matching' modifies the leaflet and links it to the actual model.

05 · Conversations

1. The leaflet and the trim are separate follow-ups - A plumber hands over a basin package to the client.
2. The test record covers only one area - A plumber clarifies a record's scope with a facilities representative.
3. The callback is a review, not a diagnosis - A plumber confirms a follow-up appointment with an owner.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The new caretaker receives an incomplete pack

The asset register identifies basin D2, fictional model Basin-Q24. Its model-matching leaflet link is broken, but the model reference and installation entry are present. The outgoing coordinator can request a replacement link from the supplier.

Role A: Plumber: distinguish missing access to the leaflet from missing installation information.

Role B: Caretaker: accept document-retrieval follow-up and repeat back asset D2, model Basin-Q24.

Possible opening: The register identifies D2, but its leaflet link doesn't open.

Success checks

- Preserve the known asset entry.
- Identify the broken document link.
- Agree who retrieves the matching leaflet.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests deleting D2 from the register because the link is broken.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

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Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Plumbers, Pipefitters, and Steamfitters

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/construction-and-extraction/plumbers-pipefitters-and-steamfitters.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Plumbers, Pipefitters, and Steamfitters (47-2152.00), U.S. Department of Labor-sponsored occupational profile

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/47-2152.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Plumbing Workplace English

Professional audience: Plumbers, supervised plumbing apprentices, plumbing service coordinators, and plumbing crew leads

Scope: Original fictional English practice, not plumbing instruction, diagnosis, design, legal advice, or guidance on operating water or drainage systems. Every incident, dimension, product, price basis, and schedule is invented. Do not open, test, dismantle, clear, pressurize, or operate equipment to enact a scenario. Installation, testing, concealed-service assessment, and safety decisions require qualified personnel and project-specific procedures. No universal code or permit rules are stated; source profiles establish occupational context only.

Lesson 01: Identifying fixtures and service history

Original fictional case: A tenant reports a problem with the bathroom sink in Unit 3B. The building has both a basin in the bathroom and a utility sink beside it. The tenant means the bathroom basin and noticed water on its cabinet base at 07:00. No source is established.

Language workshop: Locate the fixture before naming a cause

Communication goal: Clarify everyday fixture names and record the source of an account.

Language guidance: Clients may use sink for different fixtures. Ask for room, unit, and fixture references rather than inferring a pipe route. This is an information-gathering exercise, not a request to test, dismantle, or operate plumbing.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Do you mean the ___ or the ___? / Where did you notice ___? / I will record ___ as your observation, not ___.

Vocabulary: fixture: A plumbing-connected item such as a sink, basin, toilet, or shower that supplies or receives water. / branch line: A smaller piping route that connects part of a system to a larger main or distribution line. / riser: A vertical pipe or group of pipes serving different levels of a building. / service

history: The record of earlier reported plumbing issues, visits, findings, and work for an identified location or asset.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the tenant. Clarify the fixture and when you noticed the water.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The manager calls it a riser leak. Preserve the tenant's observation without accepting the unverified pipe diagnosis.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Could you confirm whether you mean the bathroom basin or the utility sink beside it? I will record water on the bathroom cabinet base at 07:00 as your observation. That identifies the affected location, not the source. We can link this visit to the correct fixture's service history without assuming which pipe is involved.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt a supported occupational language lesson

1. Ask for learner support needs, group size and time. Offer two B2 learners and 20 minutes as a default and wait for confirmation.
2. Use the reference's real language goal, terms and case facts. Provide a timed plan containing reading, four-choice dialogue gaps, scaffolded speaking, focused feedback and a retry. No activity may require open-ended writing.
3. Give two separate speaking role cards with known facts, an objective, a possible opening, one question to resolve and three success checks. Put model responses in a separate teacher section. Label invented complications and preserve uncertainty.
4. Include four original gap-fill exchanges with four plausible options each and exactly one answer. Provide option-specific explanations separately. B1 support adds a word bank and frames; C1 stretch uses more nuanced choices and spoken follow-up, not essays. Include solo rehearsal of both roles.
5. Check facts, terminology, answer uniqueness and timing before presenting the plan. Finish with a four-choice exit question and an optional spoken retry. Do not certify proficiency or teach professional procedures.

END PROMPT

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Plumbing Workplace English

Professional audience: Plumbers, supervised plumbing apprentices, plumbing service coordinators, and plumbing crew leads

Scope: Original fictional English practice, not plumbing instruction, diagnosis, design, legal advice, or guidance on operating water or drainage systems. Every incident, dimension, product, price basis, and schedule is invented. Do not open, test, dismantle, clear, pressurize, or operate equipment to enact a scenario. Installation, testing, concealed-service assessment, and safety decisions require qualified personnel and project-specific procedures. No universal code or permit rules are stated; source profiles establish occupational context only.

Lesson 01: Identifying fixtures and service history

Original fictional case: A tenant reports a problem with the bathroom sink in Unit 3B. The building has both a basin in the bathroom and a utility sink beside it. The tenant means the bathroom basin and noticed water on its cabinet base at 07:00. No source is established.

Language workshop: Locate the fixture before naming a cause

Communication goal: Clarify everyday fixture names and record the source of an account.

Language guidance: Clients may use sink for different fixtures. Ask for room, unit, and fixture references rather than inferring a pipe route. This is an information-gathering exercise, not a request to test, dismantle, or operate plumbing.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Do you mean the ___ or the ___? / Where did you notice ___? / I will record ___ as your observation, not ___.

Vocabulary: fixture: A plumbing-connected item such as a sink, basin, toilet, or shower that supplies or receives water. / branch line: A smaller piping route that connects part of a system to a larger main or distribution line. / riser: A vertical pipe or group of pipes serving different levels of a building. / service

history: The record of earlier reported plumbing issues, visits, findings, and work for an identified location or asset.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the tenant. Clarify the fixture and when you noticed the water.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The manager calls it a riser leak. Preserve the tenant's observation without accepting the unverified pipe diagnosis.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Could you confirm whether you mean the bathroom basin or the utility sink beside it? I will record water on the bathroom cabinet base at 07:00 as your observation. That identifies the affected location, not the source. We can link this visit to the correct fixture's service history without assuming which pipe is involved.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the wording to the listener

1. Quote one actual utterance from the reference. Identify its purpose, audience and degree of certainty. Offer a colleague, supervisor or outside customer as the new listener. Wait for my selection.
2. Supply four possible versions A-D and a specific constraint, such as explaining an unfamiliar abbreviation without changing a pending decision into approval. Make exactly one version satisfy all constraints. Wait for my choice.
3. Explain the strengths and limitations of every option. Treat valid stylistic alternatives as alternatives, not mistakes; rewrite an ambiguous question instead of rejecting reasonable English. Avoid national stereotypes.
4. Continue with three short, role-labelled exchanges in which I select the missing reply from four choices. Include a clarification and a disagreement. Wait after each item and invite a spoken rehearsal after feedback.
5. Finish with two complete model exchanges for different listeners. Identify what changed and what stayed the same. Do not assign open-ended writing.

END PROMPT